

clients and did not advertise as an investment advisor. And it was in this way that Father structured his business on his return from military service. With the fame from *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits*, he could easily maintain as clients a few very wealthy local families who paid him well and yet required no real organization to support him. That allowed him to feel superior to others who required a more public clientele and to remain a very private person, which fit well with his social awkwardness and insecurity. Despite his fame and notoriety, he always felt uncomfortable in the public spotlight and avoided it.

Flashback to 1945. Herbert Dougall was hired by Stanford and started the Graduate School of Business's first dedicated investment course. In all of history, only three people ever taught that course. Dougall taught it from 1946 to 1968, twenty-two years in all, except for a two-year sabbatical in 1961 and 1962 when Father taught the course on a part-time, temporary basis. Among Father's students was Jack McDonald, who was hired by Stanford in 1968 and who has taught the course ever since. When Dougall was away, it was largely on my father's reputation deriving from *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits* and from his alum-nus status that caused him to be picked. Father loved it. It revived his youthful love affair with Stanford. Had Dougall not returned, I could envision my father doing that course, part time, forever. But Dougall did return, and Jack McDonald took over in 1968. By Jack's testimony, it was Father who got him interested in markets. Before that, Jack had been a young Hewlett-Packard engineer who changed the course of his life's work at the junction when he met Father. Jack has since said that Father's major contribution, as seen through *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits*, is to be the first person to link the models of sustainable growth with the concept of competitive advantage. Today, that is a pretty standard package, but not then. In some ways Jack sees Father more as a seminal strategist than as a stock market innovator or operator.

Anyway, for the many students and business folks who hold Stanford in awe and respect its MBAs highly and who think those who took its graduate investment course advantaged, note: For a very long time, that course was taught either by the author of the book you hold in your hand (for two years) or by his disciple, and by only one man before, ever. What a testament to *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits*—one few readers